

1. Questions

In the table given below two columns are given to connect the sentence. The sentence given in column A may or may not be connected with column B contextually and grammatically. You have to identify possible combinations to combine the sentence from column A to column B. If any possible connections are not found from the option, choose “None of these” as your answer.

Column A	Column B
A). Bank credit growth has stayed strong,	1). cannot assume that energy markets will remain benign.
B). Recent estimates suggest that achieving net zero	2). could require investments exceeding \$20 trillion by 2070.
C). Geopolitical risks remain elevated, and India	3). pointing to sustained economic activity.

- A-3, B-2 and C-1
- B-3 and C-1
- A-1 and C-2
- A-2, B-3 and C-1
- None of these

2. Questions

Column A	Column B
A). For decades, India's welfare architecture was	1). plagued by leakages, inefficiencies and layers of intermediaries.
B). The economy has demonstrated that it can	2). withstand a major external shock.
C). More strikingly, 35% of children under five are	3). unexpected kindness of those who stepped forward.

- C-1
- A-2, B-3 and C-1
- A-2 and C-3

- d. A-1 and B-2
- e. None of these

3. Questions

Column A	Column B
A). A combination of slack age verification systems	1). which replaces a two-decade-old scheme.
B). It is the unexpected kindness	2). achieved merely by increasing welfare expenditure.
C). PM Modi recognised that genuine empowerment could not be	3). and technological workarounds makes a mockery of a ban.

- a. A-3
- b. B-3 and C-1
- c. A-3 and C-2
- d. A-2, C-3 and B-1
- e. None of these

4. Questions

Column A	Column B
A). A yearly 60-day closure of the job window	1). it has become a public utility.
B). A separate financing scheme of ₹10,000 crore scale for private	2). have explicitly been designed.
C). Digital access is no longer an urban privilege;	3). buses and trucks is reportedly under consideration.

- a. C-1 and B-3
- b. A-2, B-3 and C-1
- c. A-2 and C-1
- d. C-3 and B-2

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e. None of these

5. Questions

Column A	Column B
A). Soft power today operates within the complex	1). model makes for impressive mapping.
B). A dense cluster of rooftops visible to a	2). architecture of state and non-state actors.
C). Once credibility is weakened, even strong cultural or	3). institutional assets lose their impact.

- a. B-1 and C-3
- b. A-2 and C-3
- c. A-1, B-3 and C-2
- d. A-2, B-3 and C-1
- e. None of these

6. Questions

In the questions given below, choose the synonym-antonym pair of the given word.

Abject

- 1). unfeigned
- 2). despicable
- 3). queer
- 4). praiseworthy

- a. 1-4
- b. 2-4
- c. 2-3
- d. 1-3
- e. 3-4

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7. Questions

Arraign

1). incriminate

2). dishonor

3). exculpate

4). soothe

a. 1-2

b. 1-4

c. 1-3

d. 2-4

e. 3-4

8. Questions

Candid

1). hasten

2). blunt

3). evasive

4). latent

a. 1-3

b. 1-4

c. 2-4

d. 1-2

e. 2-3

9. Questions

Hamstrung

1). cripple

2). encourage

3). folly

4). renovate

a. 1-3

b. 2-4

c. 2-3

d. 1-2

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e. 3-4

10. Questions

Mandatory

- 1). humble
 - 2). imperative
 - 3). optional
 - 4). unpretentious
- a. 1-2
 - b. 2-4
 - c. 2-3
 - d. 1-4
 - e. 3-4

11. Questions

In the following sentences, identify the segment which is error-free and mark your answer accordingly.

- A). This river is the deeper than any other river in the district.
 - B). The project has remained on schedule for three consecutive years.
 - C). A number of researchers has supported the new climate policy.
 - D). Even though the glacier has shrink, it still supports several freshwater streams.
 - E). Technology have quietly dismantled barriers that persisted for decades.
- a. A
 - b. B
 - c. C
 - d. D
 - e. E

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12. Questions

- A). The language of communication must be authentic, people-centric and globally conscious.
- B). The teacher advised the students to verify every fact.
- C). The trail, once ignored by tourists, has become a favourite among birdwatchers.
- D). The report exposed the systemic flaws that had remained clandestine for decades.

E). All are correct

- a. A
- b. B
- c. C
- d. D
- e. E

13. Questions

- A). Despite of heavy snowfall, the rescue mission continued.
- B). Neither the officers nor the minister were present.
- C). Apart from minor damage, the ancient mural remained remarkably intact.
- D). Scarcely had the meeting begun then the power failed.
- E). The cleaner the river becomes, greater the diversity of fish it supports.

- a. A
- b. B
- c. C
- d. D
- e. E

14. Questions

- A). There is too much plastic waste along the shoreline.
- B). Little progress was made because the funds arrive late.
- C). Every chapters offers a different perspective on cultural traditions.
- D). Unless the waste is recycled, pollution would increase.
- E). All are correct

- a. A
- b. B
- c. C
- d. D
- e. E

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15. Questions

- A). Few ecosystems are better protected then this wetland.

- B). The valley is known for it's unusually rich plant diversity.
- C). Either the engineer or the workers is inspecting the dam.
- D). No other sanctuary in the state is as diverse as this one.
- E). The little water stored on the pond was reserved for cattle.

- a. A
- b. B
- c. C
- d. D
- e. E

16. Questions

In each question given below, a word has been highlighted in the sentences. The highlighted word may be used correctly or incorrectly based on its meaning and usage. Read all the sentences carefully and identify the option that contains the sentence(s) in which the highlighted word has been used correctly.

Demarcate

- 1). Before construction began, engineers used bright markers to **demarcate** the boundaries of the proposed highway.
 - 2). During the ceremony, volunteers **demarcated** the audience with enthusiastic applause.
 - 3). International agreements help **demarcate** maritime borders between neighboring countries.
- a. Only 2
 - b. All 1, 2 and 3
 - c. Only 3
 - d. Both 2 and 3
 - e. Both 1 and 3

17. Questions

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Debris

- 1). Following the cyclone, emergency workers spent several days clearing **debris** from major roads.
 - 2). Fragments of **debris** from the damaged satellite were carefully tracked by space agencies.
 - 3). She packed her travel documents neatly inside the **debris** before leaving home.
- a. Both 1 and 2
 - b. All 1, 2 and 3

- c. Only 3
- d. Both 2 and 3
- e. Only 2

18. Questions

Nudge

- 1). During the workshop, participants **nudged** the projector into a mathematical equation.
 - 2). Rising fuel prices may **nudge** commuters to use public transport more frequently.
 - 3). Hoping to get her friend's attention without interrupting the meeting, she gave him a gentle **nudge**.
- a. All 1, 2 and 3
 - b. Both 1 and 3
 - c. Only 3
 - d. Both 2 and 3
 - e. Only 1

19. Questions

Whopping

- 1). After months of preparation, the company reported a **whopping** increase in quarterly profits.
 - 2). Nearly everyone was shocked by the **whopping** size of the ancient banyan tree.
 - 3). Smita replied with a **whopping** whisper that only the person beside her could hear.
- a. Both 1 and 3
 - b. Both 1 and 2
 - c. Only 2
 - d. Both 2 and 3
 - e. All 1, 2 and 3

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20. Questions

Stifle

- 1). Despite facing repeated setbacks, she refused to let fear **stifle** her ambitions.
 - 2). During the ceremony, volunteers **stified** the stage with beautiful flowers.
 - 3). She tried to **stifle** her laughter during the serious meeting.
- a. Both 1 and 3
 - b. All 1, 2 and 3

- c. Only 1
- d. Both 2 and 3
- e. Only 2

21. Questions

In the following question, a passage has been given and followed by several questions. You are required to answer the questions based on the information provided in the passage.

Some remarkable people I have encountered over the years have left me the fragments of some special insights. One of them is that there are two very different ways of looking at life. One way, in fact the predominant way, is actuarial. It is popular because it is simple. You see life as a straight line with four distinct phases. The infancy phase, when you are nurtured by your family, mostly your parents. The learning phase, when you take lessons, in a school or a college, or in a trade, in your family or a vocational school. Then the longest phase, when you work in an office, a factory, a store or a trade. Finally, the retirement phase, when you don't work any more or work very little and depend on your past earnings and modest living. At the end of these four phases, you are waiting, healthy or infirm, capable or sick, for the curtain to drop.

There are legends linked to these phases. People speak nostalgically of their childhood. The roseate, playful days, under the **benign** eyes of indulgent parents. They recall their school and college days as building blocks of durable friendship and, with some luck, a lively link with a teacher or professor who can become an influential mentor. Then the long period of working days, of acquiring skills, applying them and gaining some recognition for precious competence. And, finally, the restful period of leisure, easy days, when one can live without stress, enjoy leisure, bask in the warmth of family affection.

[A1] I just have to **speak** of this **trajectory** for you to see that **there** are plenty of **ecxeptions**. Not all children have a happy childhood. In fact, thousands are orphans; many more are subject to neglect or abuse. Learning institutions are not happy abodes either for thousands; those are often certificate-dispensing bureaucracies where most denizens are bored, turned-off or see their incarceration as a period of obligatory half-leisure. For some, work is generally pleasant, absorbing, at least easy-going, but for the vast majority it is **dreary** and repetitive or oppressive and miserable. The last phase, the period of retirement may be restful and enjoyable for the well-heeled few; for the much larger number it is period of economic uncertainty, dependence on undependable children, and a cycle of monotony and concern. This is the actuarial view of life, based on naïve hopes, lucky breaks and extended periods of boredom and misery. The problem is less of life than our view of it.

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My morning coffee was interrupted today by a stunning line from Blaise Pascal. "Man is equally incapable of seeing the nothingness from which he emerges," wrote the French 17th century mathematician and philosopher, "and the infinity in which he is engulfed." However much we know about genes, whatever skills we gain in genetic engineering, we are still a mystery: we emerge from nothingness. However much we know about ourselves, whatever our proficiency in mapping our abilities, we are still inept in understanding the infinity in which we are always engulfed. Our possibilities are endless. We can grow and change; we can defy a thousand barriers and limitations. Our history tells us we can achieve the impossible, even imagine the unimaginable.

Which of the following word is the synonym of the word "dreary" as used in the third paragraph of

the passage?

- a. Tedious
- b. Exciting
- c. Pleasant
- d. Both B and C
- e. None of these

22. Questions

Why does the author mention children who are neglected or abused and workers whose jobs are oppressive?

- a. To argue that childhood is more difficult than adulthood
- b. To challenge the belief that every stage of life is naturally rewarding
- c. To prove that education is responsible for social inequality
- d. To suggest that retirement should begin earlier
- e. To demonstrate that success depends entirely on wealth

23. Questions

Which of the following conclusions best follows from the passage?

- 1). A meaningful understanding of life requires recognising both its uncertainties and human potential.
 - 2). Every person's life inevitably follows the same sequence of experiences.
 - 3). Scientific knowledge has removed the need for philosophical reflection.
- a. Both 2 and 3
 - b. Only 3
 - c. Both 1 and 2
 - d. All 1, 2 and 3
 - e. Only 1

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24. Questions

Which of the following statements is/are CORRECT according to the passage?

- I). According to the passage, the actuarial view assumes that life progresses through four broad stages.
- II). The author believes that every individual experiences these stages in an identical manner.
- III). The quotation from Blaise Pascal is used to highlight both the mystery of human origins and the vastness of human possibilities.

- a. Both I and III
- b. Both I and II
- c. Both II and III
- d. Only III
- e. All I, II and III

25. Questions

According to the passage, why is the actuarial view of life popular?

- a. It encourages people to take greater risks throughout life
- b. It presents life in a simple and orderly sequence of stages
- c. It is supported by every philosopher mentioned in the passage
- d. It guarantees success to those who follow it carefully
- e. None of these

26. Questions

Which of the following word is the antonym of the word "benign" as used in the second paragraph of the passage?

- a. Fickle
- b. Arbitrary
- c. Stable
- d. Hostile
- e. None of these

27. Questions

What does the author suggest about retirement in the actuarial model?

- a. Every retired person enjoys complete financial independence
- b. Retirement is always the happiest period of life
- c. The reality of retirement often differs from the ideal picture
- d. Retirement should begin immediately after formal education
- e. Older people usually avoid depending on their families

28. Questions

Which of the following best describes the purpose of the examples given in the third paragraph?

- a. To explain why education should be compulsory

- b. To show that people's lives rarely fit one perfect pattern
- c. To compare modern life with ancient traditions
- d. To prove that wealth guarantees lifelong happiness
- e. To encourage everyone to retire at an earlier age

29. Questions

Which of the following statements is TRUE according to the passage?

- a. The author believes that human possibilities are limited by birth
- b. Pascal believed that human beings completely understand themselves
- c. Scientific progress has answered every question about human existence
- d. Human beings can continue to grow despite many limitations
- e. All of the above

30. Questions

The sentence marked as A1 has four highlighted words out of which some word(s) are used inappropriately. Choose the words used incorrectly here.

- a. speak
- b. trajectory
- c. there
- d. ecceptions
- e. All are correct

31. Questions

In the given questions, select the synonym of the highlighted word.

Chronic food insecurity contributes to **stunting** among toddlers in the region.

- a. reigning
- b. thriving
- c. flourishing
- d. Both B and C
- e. underdeveloped

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32. Questions

Jayshree **relinquished** control of the project to her deputy.

- a. smacked

- b. retained
- c. surrendered
- d. staggered
- e. Both A and D

Explanations:

1. Questions

Answer: A

❑ **A-3:** Bank credit growth has stayed strong, pointing to sustained economic activity.

❑ **B-2:** Recent estimates suggest that achieving net zero could require investments exceeding \$20 trillion by 2070.

❑ **C-1:** Geopolitical risks remain elevated, and India cannot assume that energy markets will remain benign.

2. Questions

Answer: D

❑ **A-1:** For decades, India's welfare architecture was plagued by leakages, inefficiencies and layers of intermediaries.

❑ **B-2:** The economy has demonstrated that it can withstand a major external shock.

3. Questions

Answer: C

❑ **A-3:** A combination of slack age verification systems and technological workarounds makes a mockery of a ban.

❑ **C-2:** PM Modi recognised that genuine empowerment could not be achieved merely by increasing welfare expenditure.

4. Questions

Answer: A

❑ **B-3:** A separate financing scheme of ₹10,000 crore scale for private buses and trucks is reportedly under consideration.

❑ **C-1:** Digital access is no longer an urban privilege; it has become a public utility.

5. Questions

Answer: B

❑ **A-2:** Soft power today operates within the complex architecture of state and non-state actors.

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❑ C-3: Once credibility is weakened, even strong cultural or institutional assets lose their impact.

6. Questions

Answer: B

❑ Abject means extremely bad, miserable, or despicable.

- **Despicable:** contemptible; deserving hatred or dislike.
- **Praiseworthy:** deserving praise.
- **Unfeigned:** genuine; sincere.
- **Queer:** strange; unusual.

Thus, 2-4 is the correct pair.

7. Questions

Answer: C

❑ Arraign means to charge formally in court; also to accuse or blame.

- **Incriminate:** to accuse or show evidence against.
- **Exculpate:** to clear from blame.
- **Dishonor:** bring shame to.
- **Soothe:** calm or comfort.

Thus, 1-3 is the correct pair.

8. Questions

Answer: E

❑ Candid means honest, open, and frank.

- **Blunt:** straightforward, direct.
- **Evasive:** avoiding directness.
- **Hasten:** hurry.
- **Latent:** hidden; not yet visible.

Thus, 2-3 is the correct pair.

9. Questions

Answer: D

❑ Hamstrung means crippled, severely hindered, or made ineffective.

- **Cripple:** disable or severely hinder.
- **Encourage:** support or give confidence.
- **Folly:** foolishness.
- **Renovate:** repair or improve.

Thus, 1-2 is the correct pair.

10. Questions

Answer: C

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❑ Mandatory means required; compulsory.

- **Imperative:** absolutely necessary; compulsory.
- **Optional:** not required.
- **Humble:** modest.
- **Unpretentious:** simple, not showy.

Thus, 2-3 is the correct pair.

11. Questions

Answer: B

❑ **Sentence A:** Use “deeper” only in a comparative structure, not “the deeper.”

❑ **Sentence C:** “Has supported” should be “have supported” because “a number of” takes plural verb agreement.

❑ **Sentence D:** It should be “has shrunk”, not “has shrink.”

❑ **Sentence E:** Technology “has”, not “have.”

12. Questions

Answer: E

❑ All sentences are grammatically and contextually correct.

13. Questions

Answer: C

❑ **Sentence A:** “Despite of heavy snowfall” should be “despite heavy snowfall.”

❑ **Sentence B:** Neither...nor takes the verb according to the nearer subject. Thus, it should be “was present.”

❑ **Sentence D:** “Then the power failed” should be “when the power failed.” Scarcely...when is correct.

❑ **Sentence E:** It should be “the greater the diversity”, not “greater the diversity” alone.

14. Questions

Answer: A

❑ **Sentence B:** It should be “funds arrived.” Present tense “arrive” does not fit.

❑ **Sentence C:** “Every chapters” should be “every chapter.”

❑ **Sentence D:** “Would increase” should be “will increase.”

15. Questions

Answer: D

❑ **Sentence A:** It should be “better than”, not “better then.”

❑ **Sentence B:** It should be “known for its”, not “known for it’s.”

❑ **Sentence C:** After either...or, the verb agrees with the nearer subject. Thus, workers are inspecting.

❑ **Sentence E:** “On the pond” should be “in the pond.”

16. Questions

Answer: E

❑ Demarcate means to mark, define, or establish the limits or boundaries of something.

- **Sentence 1** is correct because engineers mark the boundaries before construction.
- **Sentence 2** is incorrect because applause cannot be used to mark or define people or physical boundaries.
- **Sentence 3** is correct since international borders are often officially demarcated.

17. Questions

Answer: A

❑ Debris refers to scattered fragments, remains, or wreckage left after destruction or damage.

- **Sentences 1 and 2** correctly describe physical remains after disasters or accidents.
- **Sentence 3** is incorrect because debris is not a container in which documents can be stored.

18. Questions

Answer: D

❑ Nudge means to push gently or to encourage someone subtly toward a particular action.

- **Sentence 1** is incorrect because the sentence is logically meaningless.
- **Sentence 2** is correct because economic conditions can gradually influence people's choices.
- **Sentence 3** correctly uses the literal meaning of a gentle push.

19. Questions

Answer: B

❑ Whopping means extremely large, impressive, or unusually great in amount or size.

- **Sentences 1 and 2** correctly describe something exceptionally large.
- **Sentence 3** is incorrect because a whisper cannot logically be whopping.

20. Questions

Answer: A

❑ Stifle means to suppress, restrain, or make it difficult for something to develop or continue. It can also mean to make breathing difficult.

- **Sentence 1** is correct because fear can prevent or suppress ambition.
- **Sentence 2** is incorrect because stifle does not mean to decorate or cover something with flowers.
- **Sentence 3** correct usage. “Stifle” means to suppress or control her laughter.

21. Questions

Answer: A

❑ “Dreary” means dull, monotonous, or lacking excitement. Tedious is the closest synonym in the given

context.

- **Option (B):** Exciting is the opposite of dreary.
- **Option (C):** Pleasant suggests enjoyment, unlike dreary.

22. Questions

Answer: B

☐ These examples illustrate that the commonly accepted life pattern does not apply universally, thereby questioning idealised assumptions about different life stages.

- **Option (A):** The comparison is not limited to childhood and adulthood.
- **Option (C):** The passage does not blame education for inequality.
- **Option (D):** Retirement age is not the focus of these examples.
- **Option (E):** Wealth is discussed only in relation to retirement, not as the sole determinant of success.

23. Questions

Answer: E

☐ The passage concludes by moving beyond a rigid life model and emphasising the limitless possibilities for growth despite uncertainty and incomplete knowledge.

- **Option (2):** This directly contradicts the author's argument.
- **Option (3):** The passage uses philosophy to complement scientific understanding.

24. Questions

Answer: A

☐ **Statement I** is correct because the passage clearly outlines four stages in the actuarial model.

☐ **Statement II** is incorrect because the author repeatedly argues that people experience life very differently.

☐ **Statement III** is correct since Pascal's quotation is used to emphasise both human mystery and limitless potential.

25. Questions

Answer: B

☐ The author explicitly states that the actuarial view is popular because it is simple, presenting life as a straight line divided into four predictable phases.

- **Option (A):** The passage never connects the actuarial view with risk-taking.
- **Option (C):** Philosophers are mentioned later for a different discussion, not to support the actuarial model.
- **Option (D):** The author actually questions the assumptions behind this model rather than presenting it as a guarantee of success.

26. Questions

Answer: D

❑ "Benign" means kind, gentle, or harmless. Its opposite is hostile, meaning unfriendly or harmful.

- **Fickle:** volatile, likely to change frequently.
- **Arbitrary:** random.

27. Questions

Answer: C

❑ The author points out that while retirement is often imagined as peaceful, many people actually face financial uncertainty, dependence, and monotony.

- **Option (A):** The passage says many retirees experience economic insecurity.
- **Option (B):** The author argues that this ideal is not true for everyone.
- **Option (D):** No such suggestion is made.
- **Option (E):** The passage specifically mentions dependence on children in many cases.

28. Questions

Answer: B

❑ The author uses examples from childhood, education, work, and retirement to demonstrate that real life is far more varied than the idealised actuarial model suggests.

- **Option (A):** The focus is on varied life experiences, not compulsory education.
- **Option (C):** Ancient and modern societies are not compared.
- **Option (D):** Wealth is mentioned only in the context of retirement and is not shown as a guarantee of happiness.
- **Option (E):** Retirement age is not discussed as a recommendation.

29. Questions

Answer: D

❑ The author concludes that people possess enormous potential to change, improve, and overcome barriers.

- **Option (A):** The passage says our possibilities are endless.
- **Option (B):** Pascal's quotation emphasizes human ignorance, not complete understanding.
- **Option (C):** The author clearly says many mysteries remain unresolved.

30. Questions

Answer: D

❑ [D]: The correct word is "exceptions."

- **Corrected sentence:**

I just have to **speak** of this **trajectory** for you to see that **there** are plenty of **exceptions**.

31. Questions

Answer: E

❑ Stunting means causing something, especially a child's growth, to become smaller, weaker, or underdeveloped.

- **Reigning:** ruling or being in power.

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- **Thriving:** growing well; flourishing.
- **Flourishing:** doing very well; growing vigorously.

32. Questions

Answer: C

❑ Relinquished means gave up, let go of, or surrendered control.

- **Smacked:** slapped.
- **Retained:** kept; held on to.
- **Staggered:** walked unsteadily.

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